Genna Gonzaga

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Education

Columbia University, B.A. in Computer Science, Minor in Visual Arts — New York, NY | Aug 2023 — May 2027

Experience

Richemont — New York, NY
Software Engineering Intern (Summer & Academic Year) — Jun 2026 — Present

- Shipped **10 features across 4 internal apps** used by **1,000+ employees** at Richemont, Cartier, and Van Cleef & Arpels, owning design end to end: research on user needs, user flows, database schemas, visual assets (Illustrator, Photoshop, Figma), and React/Node.js/SQL code.
- Designed and built an approval feature that replaced a scattered email process, cutting turnaround **from days to hours**.
- Built an **AI-powered summary feature** on an internal LLM that reached **80% adoption** (tracked in Google Analytics), partnering with cross-functional e-commerce and engineering teams; now owning a new app end to end.

Bloomin' — Remote
Founding Product Designer — Jan 2025 — Present

- Built an online English school's brand and design system from scratch, then designed and built its mobile-first React landing page around the top questions from student DMs, growing inquiries **4x (10 to 40+ a month)**, driving **20% more enrollments**, and cutting repeat questions **80%**.
- Solo designing and building the full learning platform, front end to back end (React, Express), from discovery to delivery; research and usability testing with 10 students led to consolidating **5 tools into 1** and cutting setup from **20 min to 90 sec**.
- Used **AI-assisted prototyping** (Claude Code, Figma Make) so the client could test working design directions, not static mockups.

FORMAS Research Lab, UFBA — Salvador, Brazil
Researcher and Product Designer — Jun 2025 — May 2026

- Designed and built Diciobase, unifying search across Portuguese dictionaries for 5+ international institutions; in testing with **15 linguists, researchers, and librarians**, a lookup went from **23 steps to 1** (a full morning to **4 min**).
- Ran **user interviews** and task analysis with linguists; designed user flows, interaction patterns, motion, and in-context onboarding that simplify a complex data workflow.
- Built the React/TypeScript/Tailwind front end and Node.js/Express REST API bringing every dictionary's entries into one place; cut SQL query latency **40%** (680ms to 410ms).

Cambio Labs — New York, NY
AI/ML Fellow — Sep 2025 — Dec 2025

- Built recommendation features (SVM, KNN) and an NLTK NLP pipeline in Python for a platform serving **300+ entrepreneurs**.

Projects

PlatePal | Figma, Figma Make, React, Firebase, Python, Llama 3 — Sep 2025 — Dec 2025

- Primary product designer on a 4-person team building meal picks across Columbia's 12+ dining halls; ran surveys and contextual inquiries, then iterated through usability testing until **93% of testers** rated it 5/5 (n=15).
- Redesigned onboarding from 7 fields on one page into a **3-step flow**, restructured the app's information architecture, and designed an AI-powered plate of the day (Llama 3) and photo-based macro logging.
- Built the React front end and an automated Python data pipeline (Selenium, BeautifulSoup) scheduled on GitHub Actions.

Skills

Design: Figma, Adobe Illustrator, Adobe Photoshop, Google Analytics, user research (interviews, surveys, contextual inquiry), usability testing, wireframing, user flows, interaction design, visual design, typography, information architecture, visual hierarchy, layout, design systems, high-fidelity prototyping, motion design, accessibility, branding, design critiques

AI Tools: Claude Code, Cursor, Claude, Figma Make, AI-assisted prototyping, LLM-powered features

Engineering: React, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Tailwind CSS, Node.js, Express, SQL (PostgreSQL, SQL Server), Python

Leadership & Activities

ColorStack Columbia, VP of Communications — New York, NY | Mar 2024 — Present

- Lead communications for partner events with **Bloomberg, Amazon, Datadog, and Lovable**; mentor the incoming e-board.

Design for America Columbia, Design Project Lead — New York, NY | Feb 2025 — Present

- Lead the design of **Twin Pact**, a matching-algorithm platform that pairs Columbia students as friends and funds their first coffee.